MCP

Title:
The Big Decision

Author:
Mike Noland

© 2024 Mike Noland
Publication Date: December 1, 2024

Published by
MUSHROOM CLOUD PRESS
An imprint of Rainbow Skull LLC
Made in the USA

Permission for performance of this piece is granted for the purpose of performance in competition by middle school, high school, and undergraduate collegiate performers. Online, remote, and video performances are permitted for these purposes only. Video or audio recordings of performances may not be shared or posted online without permission from the publisher. Theatrical performance and all other kinds of public performance, whether broadcast, online, or on stage, are prohibited without prior written permission from Mushroom Cloud Press, an imprint of Rainbow Skull LLC.

This script is authorized for competition only if the competitor or the competitor's representative, including but not limited to parent or educational entity, has purchased a copy of the script from Mushroom Cloud Press or an authorized retailer. The script must be presented with the cover sheet bearing the ISBN. Additional requirements for performance may be made by tournament and league rules.

Tournament officials: please contact Mushroom Cloud Press to validate script purchase.

For all inquiries and to see our full catalog of scripts, visit
MushroomCloudPress.com

The Big Decision

By Mike Noland

Scene

INT: Joy's living room

Action

Joy is entering her living room. She has just gotten home from school and is unloading her backpack. Suddenly, Shelley comes in from the other room and startles Joy and the conversation begins.

Shelley

(Shelley enters with a cookie and a can of soda.) Well, I've made a huge decision. A decision that could alter the course of our lives in so many ways.

Joy

(Joy jumps and is startled.) AH! Good Lord Shelley, where did you come from?

Shelley

(Barely notices that Joy is surprised.) The kitchen, duh, where do you think I got this. (Holding up the cookie and soda.Takes a bite of the cookie.)

Joy

But school just got out. How did you get here so fast?

Shelley

I had 7th period history and you know that substitute Mr. Johnson's has?

Joy

You mean the guy who calls everyone "Dude" and "Brah"?

Shelley

Yeah that's him. Well, he's not very bright.

Joy

What do you mean?

Shelley

You know, slow… dumb… easy to fool…The text was typed but never sent…

Joy

No, I know what "not very bright means." I mean, what does the substitute have to do with anything?

Shelley

Well, I convinced him that I needed to take pictures for the yearbook and I had to go to the pool and take pictures of the swim team.

Joy

But we don't have a swim team.

Shelley

Yep

Joy

And we don't even have a pool.

Shelley

Exactly.

Joy

And you don't have a camera.

Shelley

I know, that's why I said he wasn't very bright. So, I left class early and came right over.

Joy

But what does that have to do with you breaking into my house?

Shelley

I didn't break in. I used the key.

Joy

You have a key to my house?

Shelley

No, I used the spare key that's under the dwarf in the flower bed. .

Joy

We don't have a dwarf in the flower bed and we sure don't have a spare key.

Shelley

Yes you do AND yes you do. Alicia showed me where it was several weeks ago. You know, in case I needed to get in and nobody was home. Like today. (Take a big drink of soda.)

Joy

Wait, what? First there is no dwarf in the flower bed…oh, you are talking about the garden gnome.

Shelley

Dwarf, gnome, what's the difference?

Joy

(Thinks for a second) Actually I have no idea. Second, since when have we had a spare key and it kind of creeps me out when you call my mom by her first name.

Shelley

The spare key was actually my suggestion, thank you very much. See, Alicia and I were talking and I said, "Hey Alicia, wouldn't it be a great idea to have a spare key? You could put it under the midget in the flower bed."

Joy

Ok, you can't say that, it's offensive.

Shelley

What's offensive about Alicia?

Joy

Not Alicia…midget. Don't say midget, say little person.

Shelley

It's funny, Alicia said the same thing. You two are so much alike.

Joy

Why do you keep calling her Alicia?

Shelley

Well, unless you were not aware, that is her name.

Joy

But not for you to use. That's like the name her friends use. You know, adults.

Shelley

Hmmm, let's see. A- I'm only a few months from graduating high school, which will practically make me an adult. And B- would you rather I call her Mom?

Joy

Eeeww, no. Why don't you call her Mrs. Baker or Mrs. B or you know… not Alicia?

Shelley

Alicia is right, you could loosen up a bit. You need to chill out. Enjoy life because it's like a big ole apple and you need to take a bite every once in a while.

Joy

(Shocked) You and my mom talk about me?

Shelley

Of course we do, we love you. But you can be a little…uh…rigid.

Joy

Rigid?! I'm not rigid.

Shelley

Hahaha. Alicia said you would probably say that.

Joy

Ok, you have to stop calling her Alicia or I'm gonna lose it.

Shelley

(Sing-songy) Rigid!

Joy

I'm not rigid. It's just annoying. You act like you two have been going to Pilates and driving carpool together or something. You are still a kid, like me.

Shelley

(Laughing) Pilates, that's funny. Nobody does Pilates anymore. Now hot yoga, I could go for that. I wonder if Alicia..I mean… your mom would like that?

Joy

(Talking to herself) All I wanted to do was come home, relax a little, get my homework done, and maybe watch the Real Housewives of wherever. But nooo. I come in and get attacked by my friend who has broken into my house..

Shelley

…with a key.

Joy

…with a key. And why are you here anyway.

Shelley

I told you, I have made a huge decision and I wanted to share it with you.

Joy

Don't tell me you are giving up your dream of being a TikTok star or an Instagram influencer.

Shelley

NO, never. With my natural charisma, my followers could blow up at any minute.

Joy

You only have about 43 and most of those are family members and fake profiles you made up.

Shelley

Which means my upside is unlimited. Pretty exciting, right?

Joy

I gotta give you props for being positive.

Shelley

That's a very important trait to make it in this current media climate. Or at least that's what is being said on Reddit. Or was that Insta? Doesn't matter, it's true. I am just one click away from being the next "I-did-nothing-to-deserve-this-fame-except-be-online-all-the-time." Don't worry though, I won't forget you.

Joy

Speaking of not forgetting. You have never told me why you are here. What's the big decision?

Shelley

Oh, right. After much thought and deliberation, I have decided to get…

Joy

Another tattoo?

Shelley

No, but should I?

Joy

No, because nobody has seen the first one.

Shelley

But it's there, I promise.

Joy

Are you getting a hoverboard? You really shouldn't because you aren't very coordinated. You would kill yourself.

Shelley

That's not true.

Joy

Oh really. Did you forget the ice skating disaster during Christmas break of 9th grade?

Shelley

Come on. It wasn't that big of a deal. I lost my balance and bumped into a few kids.

Joy

You wiped out half the high school hockey team and they were wearing pads. And what about the time you went bowling and somehow knocked the power out to the entire shopping center.

Shelley

Who puts the electrical thingies so close to the lane…that's just dumb.

Joy

Then there was the time you flooded the soccer field…

Shelley

Alright. Maybe I'm not the most graceful person. However, I am not getting a hoverboard. I'm getting a dog.

Joy

NO.

Shelley

Yes.

Joy

No,no.

Shelley

Yes, yes.

Joy

A dog, really?

Shelley

Really. I just think it's the perfect time and an excellent idea.

Joy

Have you ever had a pet before?

Shelley

Nope, never have.

Joy

And you think this is a great idea?

Shelley

I sure do. In fact, I doodly do do.

Joy

This is crazy. You don't have any idea about what it's like owning a dog.

Shelley

Do you?

Joy

No, but I'm not getting one.

Shelley

Or are you?

Joy

What does that mean? Or are you?

Shelley

That's the beauty of this plan. You and I will discover the joys of pet ownership along with the bonding that comes with co-parenting a deserving canine.

Joy

Co-parenting? You aren't dragging me into this insane plan of yours. I don't have a dog and I don't want a dog. I have enough to do in my life already.

Shelley

Come on now. Haven't you seen those videos? Cute little puppers with big brown eyes that look at you with nothing but love. Did you know that dogs are the only animal that loves you more than they love themselves?

Joy

Do you really think I'm gonna fall for this? I am not about to waste time during my final high school days, when I'm already writing research papers, doing projects and studying for final exams, just to help you raise a dog.

Shelley

You are looking at this all wrong. This will be a pleasure not a chore. Your life will be forever enhanced by giving your love to an animal that wants nothing more than to make you happy. Just think, you have had a tough day where nothing has gone right and then you get home and open the door and there is a fuzzy face that is so happy to see you.

Joy

Are you talking about a dog or are you making fun of my brother?

Shelley

Well, you have to admit. He looks really funny with that scraggly beard.

Joy

True.

Shelley

But yes, I'm talking about a dog. Not just any dog. Our dog. Who we will teach to be smart and loyal and friendly.

Joy

I don't have time to go to a pet store and help you pick out a dog anyway.

Shelley

Pet store! What are you? Some kind of monster?

Joy

What did I say?

Shelley

We aren't getting our dog from a pet store.

Joy

Well I didn't think you could get them from Amazon.

Shelley

(Softly laughing) Joy, Joy, Joy. You really don't get it. We are not going to get a dog from a pet store or online. We are going to rescue our dog from an animal shelter.. We are going to save a life.

Joy

(Pause.) Well, I must admit, that does sound pretty nice.

Shelley

It's not just nice, it's fantastic. We will be giving a dog a second chance and in turn, you know what we get?

Joy

Hair on our clothes and chewed up shoes?

Shelley

Instant Karma. Lots and lots of good karma.

Joy

As good as this all sounds, I'm not a dog person and up until today, neither were you.

Shelley

Hey, people change and not just their hairstyles.

Joy

But a dog is a huge responsibility.

Shelley

Exactly and Alicia… I mean your mom thinks it would be a fantastic experience. Plus, you know what they say?

Joy

Who?

Shelley

The people who say stuff, those people. They say, "The world would be a nicer place if everyone had the ability to love as unconditionally as a dog."

Joy

Wow, you are really trying to sell this. I'm still not sure. I just don't think I'm a dog person.

Shelley

That's only because you haven't been one before.

Joy

Well neither have you.

Shelley

I am now or at least I'm gonna be. With or without you. So are you going to help me or not?

Joy

(She thinks about it.) Nah, I just can't do it.

Shelley

Your loss. (She starts to walk out.)

Joy

(Watches Shelley leave and then suddenly says.) What are you gonna name it?

Shelley

(She stops and turns.) I don't know, I haven't seen it yet.

Joy

(She thinks and finally says.) Well, I guess I better go with you or you will give it some stupid name.

Shelley

(Smiles) No I won't. You will be the one that does that. (They start walking off.)

Joy

Please, I'm a great namer.

Shelley

Ha, you will probably want to call it Vanderplump or something.

Joy

Oooh, I kinda like that….
(Exit)